

Stone Strong, v. Stone Strong Caribbean,

Structural and geotechnical engineering of precast modular retaining-wall blocks, including gravity, mechanically stabilized earth, and hybrid wall configurations and geogrid connections.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-19	D. Neb.	4:26-cv-03252	Trade Secret

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Stone Strong, LLC v. Stone Strong Caribbean, LLC
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FORUM / DOCKET	D. Neb. / 4:26-cv-03252
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-19 / trade secret
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

Stone Strong, LLC v. Stone Strong Caribbean, LLC, No. 4:26-cv-03252, filed 2026-08-19 in D. Neb..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Sheila A. Bentzen - Rembolt Ludtke LLP; named matter counsel. Bentzen filed the complaint for Stone Strong and is the only plaintiff attorney identified on the public docket; her official profile identifies her as a commercial litigator and litigation-practice leader.

sbentzen@remboltlawfirm.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Structural and geotechnical engineering of precast modular retaining-wall blocks, including gravity, mechanically stabilized earth, and hybrid wall configurations and geogrid connections.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Which block geometry, mold/process details, geogrid connection designs, wall calculations, and installation methods are allegedly secret?

Which block geometry, mold/process details, geogrid connection designs, wall calculations, and installation methods are allegedly secret?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 How do gravity, MSE, and hybrid configurations transfer load and perform under settlement, surcharge, drainage, and seismic conditions?

How do gravity, MSE, and hybrid configurations transfer load and perform under settlement, surcharge, drainage, and seismic conditions?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 Could the claimed know-how be derived from public design manuals, codes, patents, testing standards, or inspection of sold blocks?

Could the claimed know-how be derived from public design manuals, codes, patents, testing standards, or inspection of sold blocks?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Jorge G. Zornberg

Professor of Civil Engineering, University of Texas at Austin

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for geosynthetic-reinforced soil, MSE walls, geogrid connections, and wall performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Extensive publications on geosynthetic-reinforced soil retaining walls and field monitoring.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Consulting and industry relationships require conflict review; precast-block manufacturing is a narrower question.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | zornberg@mail.utexas.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Kianoosh Hatami

Presidential Professor, University of Oklahoma

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for soil reinforcement, geosynthetics, and multi-tiered earth-wall systems.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 140 peer-reviewed publications in geosynthetic engineering and soil reinforcement.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Public profile does not establish experience with the specific Stone Strong block geometry.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kianoosh@ou.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Jie Han

Roy A. Roberts Distinguished Professor, University of Kansas

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for multi-tiered earth walls, geosynthetic reinforcement, ground improvement, and buried structures.

RELEVANT WORK

Research includes design methods for multi-tiered earth wall systems and geosynthetic reinforcements.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

May require separate structural/precast expertise for block connection and concrete issues.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jjehan@ku.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Abdelmalek Bouazza

Professor in Geotechnical Engineering, Monash University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for geosynthetics, large-deformation analysis, reinforced embankments, and segmental walls.

RELEVANT WORK

Internationally recognized geosynthetics researcher; work includes segmental retaining-wall systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Australia location adds logistics and his profile is broader than proprietary modular-block design.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | Malek.Bouazza@monash.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Robert Swan Jr.

Teaching Professor and associate department head, Drexel University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong applied fit for soil/geosynthetic interaction, testing, instrumentation, and field performance.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 20 years in geotechnical/geosynthetics consulting and laboratory testing before academia.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Teaching appointment may mean a smaller recent research record than research-intensive candidates.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | rhs53@drexel.edu | [public email source](#)

06 J. Brian Anderson

Elton Z. and Lois G. Huff Professor of Geotechnical Engineering, Auburn University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for earth-retaining structures, soil-structure interaction, foundations, and infrastructure performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Research profile expressly lists earth retaining structures and soil-structure interaction.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Less directly tied to geogrid connection testing or proprietary precast-block systems.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jba0005@auburn.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Aditya Parihar

Assistant Professor of Geotechnical Engineering, Thapar Institute

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for physical and numerical modeling of retaining walls, backfill, and dynamic soil response.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes on retaining-wall backfills and researches physical modeling and field investigation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

International location and more junior rank; U.S. design-code familiarity should be confirmed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | aditya.parihar@thapar.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Mehrad Kamalzare

Professor of Civil Engineering, Cal Poly Pomona

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for foundation engineering, retaining-wall design, soil characterization, and laboratory evaluation.

RELEVANT WORK

Teaches graduate soil mechanics and retaining-wall design and directs geotechnical laboratory work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited page emphasizes teaching rather than a distinctive modular-wall research program.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | mkamalzare@cpp.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 David Arellano

Associate Professor of Civil Engineering, University of Memphis

TECHNICAL FIT

Applied fit for earth-retaining design, slope stability, subsurface exploration, and failure analysis.

RELEVANT WORK

Nearly ten years of geotechnical consulting plus research on geofoam slope stabilization and design guidance.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No explicit geogrid-to-block connection publication is identified.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | darellan@memphis.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Ravi N. Ravichandran

Professor of Civil Engineering, Clemson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for geotechnical design principles applied to shallow/deep foundations and retaining walls.

RELEVANT WORK

Teaches advanced geotechnical engineering design with retaining-wall design as a core objective.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The email source is a course syllabus and should be refreshed before outreach; modular-block research is not shown.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | nravic@clemson.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/nebraska/nedce/4%3A2026cv03252/112606>

Official attorney biography and email: https://remboltlawfirm.com/attorneys/sheila-bentzen?00859cca_page=4

Public technical context source: <https://www.stonestrong.com/>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

No attorney or expert was contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts were not checked.